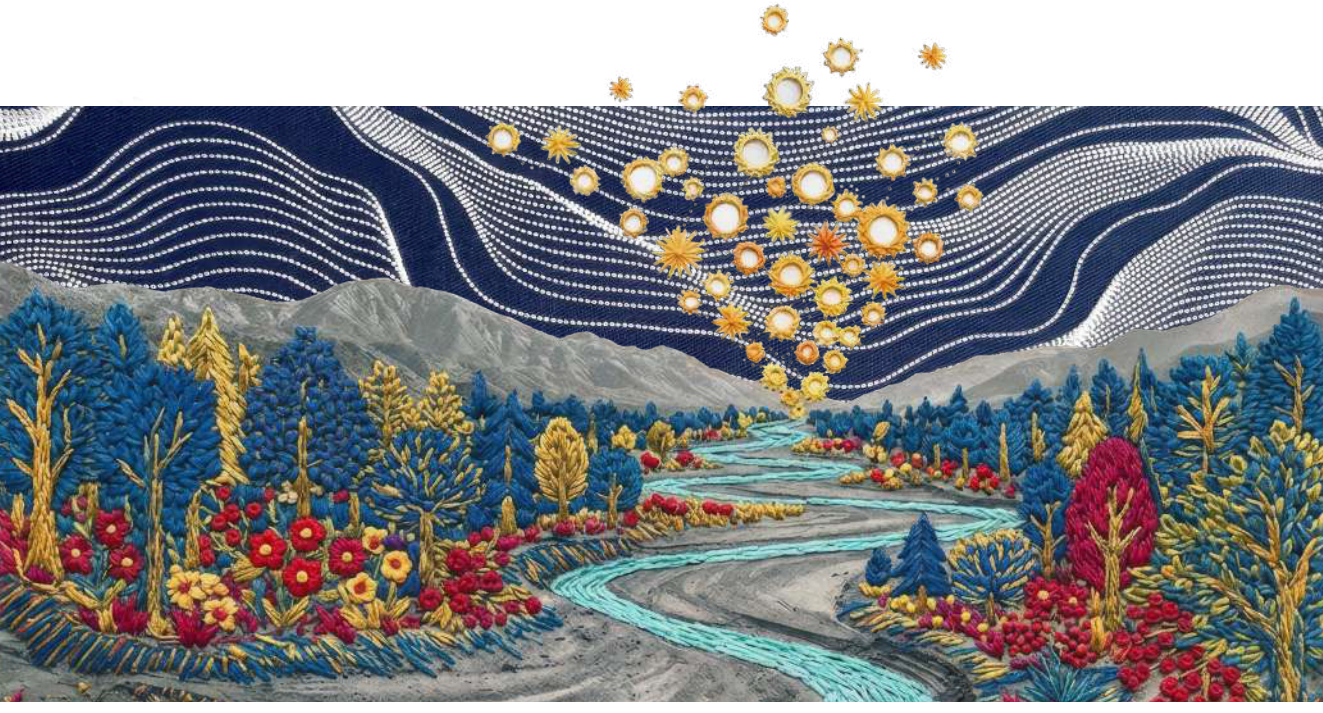
VIDYASHILP UNIVERSITY

Imagining Possibilities

DESIGNING REALITIES

Bachelor of Design (BDes)



VIDYASHILP SCHOOL OF DESIGN

About the Program

The Bachelor of Design (BDes) program at Vidyashilp University is a contemporary design education program that prepares students to engage with the rapidly changing world of communication, technology, culture, and society.



As digital media, artificial intelligence, ecological concerns, and new forms of human interaction continue to reshape everyday life, designers are increasingly required to think beyond aesthetics and functionality to address complex human and societal challenges.

The program combines creative practice, critical inquiry, research, and technological understanding to help students develop as thoughtful and responsible designers. Through studio-based learning, interdisciplinary exploration, field engagement, and collaborative projects, students learn to create meaningful experiences, visual systems, narratives, products, and services that respond to contemporary realities.

Students build strong foundations in visual communication, interaction design, storytelling, animation, digital media, design research, and emerging technologies while developing the ability to think critically, work collaboratively, and communicate effectively across disciplines.

The curriculum encourages experimentation, innovation, and social responsibility while preparing students for careers across creative industries, communication design, digital media, entrepreneurship, research, and emerging design fields.

Why Choose BDes at VU?

Design today influences nearly every aspect of contemporary life. From digital platforms and communication systems to public services, social innovation, cultural production, and emerging technologies, Design plays a critical role in shaping how people interact with the world.

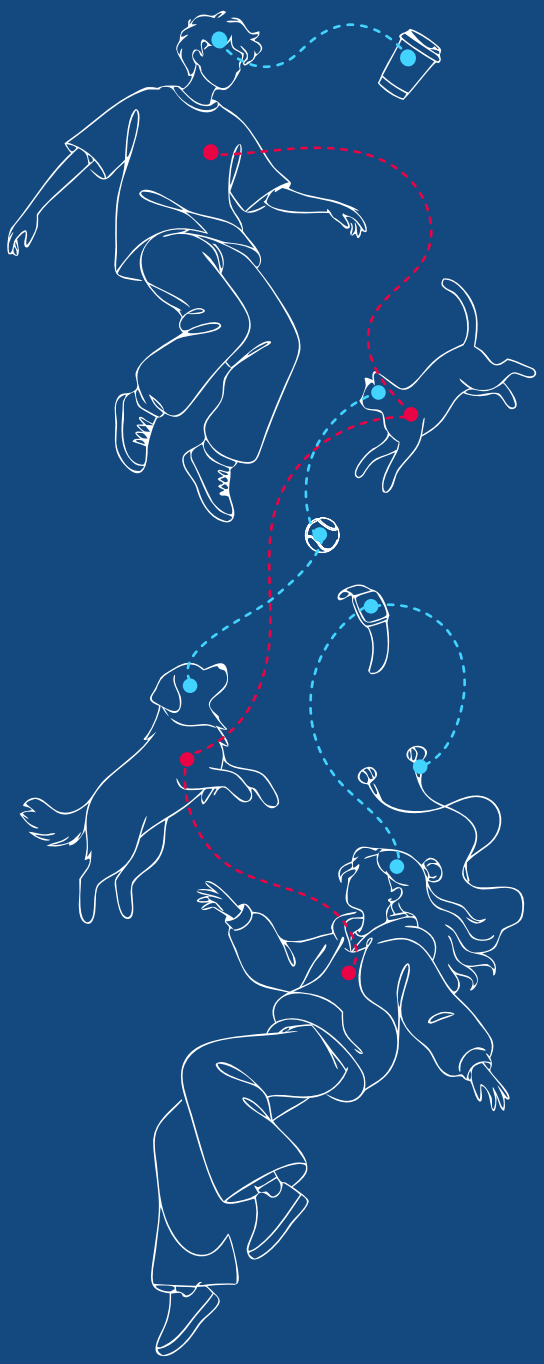
At Vidyashilp University, design education extends beyond technical skill development. Students are encouraged to explore the cultural, social, ecological, technological, and ethical dimensions of Design while developing practical skills relevant to professional practice.

The program offers a learning environment that combines academic rigor, creative experimentation, interdisciplinary collaboration, and industry engagement. Students work across diverse media and contexts while gaining exposure to contemporary design challenges through workshops, field projects, internships, research initiatives, and interactions with practitioners from around the world.

In an increasingly complex and interconnected world, the University's emphasis on critical thinking, creative adaptability, and responsible innovation enables students to develop both professional competence and intellectual confidence.



Learning Philosophy



The School of Design believes that meaningful learning emerges through making, questioning, observing, researching, collaborating, and reflecting. At Vidyashilp University's School of Design, we strongly believe that a design education should not merely train students to execute solutions, it should enable them to understand problems, challenge assumptions, and explore alternative possibilities.

The program adopts a studio-based, project-oriented approach, where students engage with real-world contexts while developing conceptual, creative, technical, and professional skills. Learning takes place through design studios, workshops, seminars, field engagement, independent projects, collaborative initiatives, and research-based inquiry.

Students are encouraged to cultivate curiosity, experimentation, empathy, and critical reflection. They learn to approach design not only as a professional discipline but also as a way of understanding society, culture, technology, and the environment.

By integrating theory and practice, the program nurtures designers who are capable of responding creatively and responsibly to contemporary challenges while remaining adaptable to future transformations.

Curriculum Overview of BDes



1 University Program Foundation

Introduction to Psychology | Introduction to Ethnography | Principles of Typography | Visualizing Data for Storytelling | Analytical Academic Writing

2 Specialization Tracks

Interaction Design | Film, Animation | Graphic Design | Comics & Sequential Art | Game Design | Immersive Media: Extended Reality (Augmented Reality / Virtual Reality / Mixed Reality)

3 Minors

Finance | Data Science | Marketing | Psychology | Law | Economics

Curriculum Structure

The Bachelor of Design (BDes) program is structured as a progressive four-year learning journey that combines foundational knowledge, creative exploration, disciplinary depth, professional practice, and independent inquiry.

The curriculum is designed to help students gradually develop visual, conceptual, technical, research, and professional competencies while building the ability to engage with complex social, cultural, technological, and ecological contexts.

Through a combination of design studios, workshops, seminars, field engagement, interdisciplinary electives, internships, and research projects, students learn to integrate creative thinking with critical inquiry and practical application.

The program follows a carefully sequenced structure that allows students to explore multiple design domains before pursuing focused specialization pathways.



Year One: Foundation: Perception, Making and Creative Inquiry

The first year establishes the intellectual, creative, and technical foundations of design education. Students are introduced to the principles of visual communication, form, perception, material exploration, storytelling, drawing, design processes, and creative problem-solving.

The emphasis is on observation, experimentation, making, and critical thinking. Students develop an understanding of design as both a creative practice and a cultural process while building confidence in visual expression and communication.

Foundation studios are complemented by courses in design history, contemporary culture, communication studies, liberal arts, and emerging technologies, enabling students to develop broader perspectives on the role of design in society.

Year Two: Exploration: Systems, Media, and Research

The second year expands students' exposure to diverse design disciplines and emerging areas of practice. Through advanced studios and interdisciplinary projects, students engage with visual communication, interaction design, storytelling, digital media, animation, user experience, publication design, and design research.

Students begin to understand the relationships between technology, culture, communication, systems, and human behavior. Greater emphasis is placed on collaboration, research methods, contextual understanding, and project development.

This stage encourages students to identify their interests while developing the conceptual and technical skills necessary for advanced study.

Year Three: Specialization and Professional Development

The third year marks the transition from broad exploration to focused disciplinary engagement. Students choose a specialization pathway aligned with their interests, strengths, and career aspirations.

The curriculum deepens professional competencies through advanced studios, industry-linked projects, collaborative assignments, and research-based learning. Students engage with contemporary challenges while developing a distinctive creative voice and professional portfolio.

Workshops, visiting faculty interactions, industry collaborations, and internships provide opportunities to apply learning within real-world contexts and professional environments.

Year Four: Research, Innovation and Independent Practice

The final year focuses on independent inquiry, advanced project development, and professional preparation. Students undertake self-directed projects, design research, collaborative initiatives, and capstone work that reflect their interests and emerging professional identities.

The emphasis shifts from guided learning toward critical exploration, innovation, experimentation, and leadership. Students are encouraged to address complex contemporary issues through design while developing rigorous research, communication, and project-management skills.

The culmination of the program is a major graduation project that demonstrates creative excellence, intellectual depth, technical competence, and professional maturity.



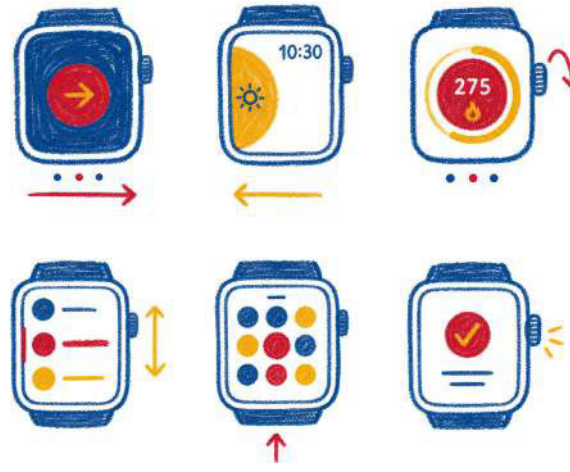
Specialization Pathways

At the end of the fourth semester, students select a specialization pathway to develop deeper expertise in a chosen area of design practice.

Interaction Design

Interaction Design focuses on the design of digital products, services, interfaces, and user experiences. Students learn to create intuitive, meaningful, and engaging interactions across digital platforms while exploring emerging technologies, user behavior, systems thinking, and experience design.

Potential career pathways include UX/UI design, product design, service design, experience design, design research, and digital innovation.





Graphic Design

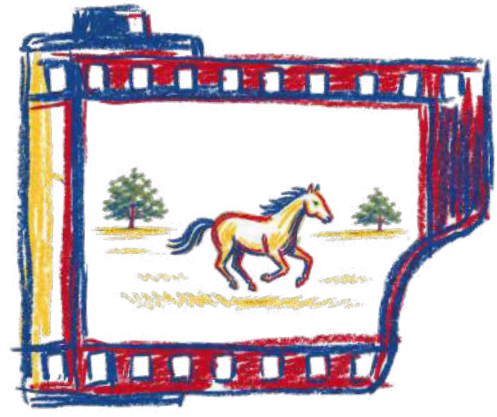
Graphic design explores visual communication across print, digital, environmental, and interactive media. Students engage with typography, branding, publication design, information design, visual systems, and communication strategy while developing strong conceptual and aesthetic capabilities.

Graduates may pursue careers in branding, editorial design, visual communication, creative direction, publication design, and communication strategy.

Film and Animation

This pathway combines narrative development, visual storytelling, motion design, animation, filmmaking, and emerging moving-image practices. Students explore both traditional and digital techniques while developing skills in storytelling, production, direction, editing, and visual communication.

Career opportunities include animation, filmmaking, motion graphics, content creation, digital media production, and visual storytelling.



Comics and Sequential Art

This specialization focuses on narrative illustration, graphic storytelling, visual narratives, character development, world-building, and sequential image-making. Students explore the relationship between text, image, culture, and storytelling across contemporary media platforms.

Graduates may pursue careers in illustration, publishing, graphic novels, visual storytelling, editorial practice, and independent creative production.



Game Design and Immersive Media (AR/VR/XR)

This pathway introduces students to interactive storytelling, game systems, immersive environments, extended reality technologies, virtual experiences, and emerging digital platforms.

Students learn to integrate narrative, technology, design thinking, and user engagement while developing innovative experiences for future media environments.

Potential career pathways include game design, immersive experience design, virtual production, XR design, interactive media, and emerging technology industries.



Learning Beyond the Classroom

Learning at Vidyashilp University extends beyond formal coursework. Students engage in workshops, field visits, cultural projects, exhibitions, industry interactions, internships, international collaborations, and interdisciplinary initiatives throughout the program.

These experiences help students connect academic learning with professional practice while developing cultural awareness, collaborative skills, adaptability, and global perspectives. The result is a design education that prepares students not only for careers but also for meaningful participation in a rapidly evolving world.



Industry Engagement and Creative Dialogues

At Vidyashilp University, learning extends beyond the classroom through interactions with designers, artists, filmmakers, researchers, entrepreneurs, and cultural practitioners from diverse professional backgrounds.

These engagements expose students to contemporary creative practices, emerging ideas, and multiple perspectives shaping the future of design.

Workshops, masterclasses, artist talks, screenings, exhibitions, and collaborative projects offer students opportunities to engage directly with practitioners whose work spans communication design, visual culture, social innovation, technology, media, and contemporary art.

These experiences encourage students to connect academic learning with professional practice while developing curiosity, critical thinking, and creative confidence.



Meditations on Paper

Led by Bengaluru-based graphic designer, illustrator, and educator Nupur Banerjee, this workshop explored drawing, illustration, storytelling, and visual expression as mindful and reflective creative practices.

Students engaged with observation, personal narratives, and experimental mark-making while discovering how creative processes can become tools for reflection, imagination, and self-expression. The workshop highlighted the relationship between artistic practice, attention, and meaningful visual communication.



Gängeviertel:
Self-Organized Art and Community Hamburg

Conducted by Hamburg-based artist and graphic designer Rita Kohel, this session introduced students to Gängeviertel, one of Europe's most recognized artist-led community initiatives.

Through discussions on creative resistance, collaborative living, cultural activism, and alternative urban spaces, students gained insights into how art and design can contribute to social engagement, collective action, and community-led cultural transformation.



A Breath Held Long

Students experienced a special screening and discussion of A Breath Held Long, an evocative short film by acclaimed Mumbai-based artist Sudarshan Shetty.

The film explores themes of memory, displacement, belonging, urban life, and human relationships within Mumbai's emotional and cultural landscape. The screening offered a unique opportunity to engage with contemporary artistic practice through cinema, narrative, and visual storytelling.

The event encouraged reflection on the ways artists use moving images to explore personal, social, and cultural realities.



International Collaborations

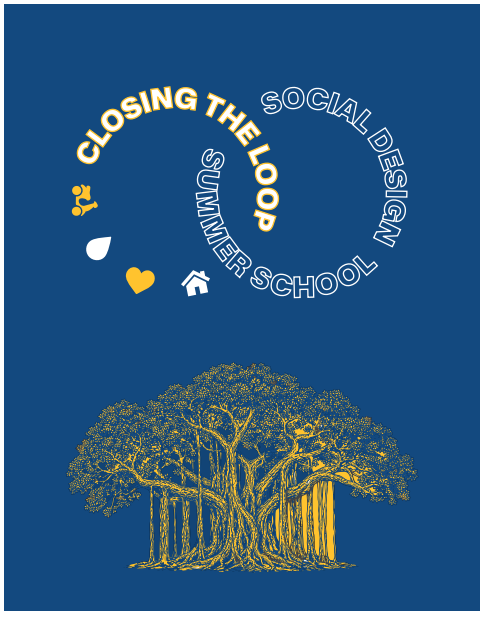
The School of Design at Vidyashilp University fosters global academic engagement through collaborations with leading international universities and design schools. Through exchange programs, summer schools, workshops, and visiting mentors, these collaborations immerse students in global design practices, diverse creative cultures, and cross-cultural learning experiences.



F+F Zurich Exchange

The collaboration with the F+F School of Art and Design, Zurich, Switzerland, offers students opportunities to engage with contemporary European art and design education.
Through exchange programs, workshops, and collaborative learning experiences, students participate in immersive studio environments that encourage experimentation, cultural exchange, and critical engagement with international creative practices.

The program enables students to develop global perspectives while experiencing different approaches to Design, art, and visual culture.



Closing the Loop

Closing the Loop is an international social design Summer School organized by the Social Design Studio at the University of Applied Arts Vienna, Austria in collaboration with Vidyashilp University Centre for Art, Design and Innovation (VUCADI).

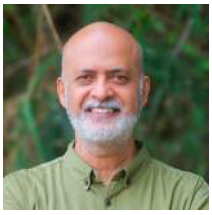
The program focuses on understanding the material and immaterial resources that shape contemporary cities and communities. Students engage with themes such as sustainability, urban culture, social innovation, ecological thinking, and community participation.

Through workshops, field engagement, lectures, and collaborative projects, participants work alongside internationally recognized artists, designers, researchers, and practitioners exploring the intersections of design, society, and environmental responsibility.

Faculty

1:7 | FACULTY STUDENT RATIO

Our faculty have trained at leading institutions including Indiana University of Pennsylvania, the National Institute of Design, and TH Köln – University of Applied Sciences, among others. Learn from their expertise, collaborate on groundbreaking research, and embark on your own journey of educational transformation.



Prof. Narendra Raghunath
Dean
School of Design
MA, CEPT University



Dr. Vasanthi Mariadass
Program Chair
School of Design
PhD, Indiana University of Pennsylvania, USA



Mr. Vakhtang Wato Tsereteli
Director
Vidyashilp University's Center for Art, Design and Innovation (VUCADI)
Founder - Center of Contemporary Art Tbilisi, Georgia



Prof. Parvatam Venkata Ramana
Professor of Practice
School of Design
Founder – Okastudio
NIFT, Delhi



Prof. Chinar Shah
Assistant Professor
School of Design
Photography Design from National Institute of Design



Prof. Kavita Singh Kale
Associate Professor
School of Design
Award-winning film director, Alumnus of National Institute of Design, Ahmedabad
B.F.A., Delhi University



Prof Upendra Vaddadi
Assistant Professor
School of Design,
TH Köln – University of Applied Sciences
BDes, Srishti Manipal Institute of Art, Design & Technology



Prof. Rajkumar Darbar
Assistant Professor
School of Design
PhD, Inria Bordeaux & University of Bordeaux, France



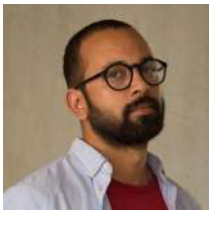
Prof. Ravinder Kumar
Assistant Professor
School of Design
PhD , Banasthali Vidyapith, Jaipur - Indian Craft (Pursuing)
M.Des, National Institute of Design, Ahmedabad



Ranjani Balasubramanian
Adjunct Faculty
School of Design
Former Faculty and Course Leader at Srishti Manipal Institute
PhD Scholar, Manipal University



Prof. Sonia Jose
Adjunct Faculty
School of Design
M.A. Professional Practice and Design in Education



Sandip Kuriakose
Adjunct Faculty
School of Design MFA, University of California, Riverside, CA
MCA (Painting), M.S., University of Baroda, Gujarat

KNOW MORE ABOUT OUR FACULTY

Shilpites Showcase

The School of Design encourages students to present their work through exhibitions, public showcases, installations, screenings, and interdisciplinary events that celebrate creativity, experimentation, and innovation.

These platforms allow students to share ideas, receive feedback, engage with broader audiences, and develop professional confidence while showcasing the diversity of work emerging from the program.

The showcase culture reflects the school's commitment to creative exploration, public engagement, and collaborative learning.

Design Show 2025

Design Show 2025 celebrated the creativity, imagination, and innovation of students across the School of Design.

The exhibition featured installations, visual communication projects, AI-inspired concepts, branding initiatives, social-impact projects, interactive experiences, and interdisciplinary explorations developed through studio learning and independent inquiry.
The event also hosted conversations with leading international practitioners, including Dr Jean-Marc Dépierre, Director of Alliance Française de Bangalore, and internationally recognized installation artist Tara Kelton, creating opportunities for dialogue between students, educators, and creative professionals.









Internship Highlights

Professional experience is an integral part of the BDes journey. Industry internships immerse students in contemporary design practice, helping them translate ideas into impact while developing professional skills, industry exposure, and career direction.

Adhira K P
Graphic Designer Intern
OPYO Studio

Aparna Prabhu
Design Intern
Design Innovation Centre,
IIT Hyderabad

G Harshada Sai
Design Intern
Design Innovation Centre,
IIT Hyderabad

Pragathi Jagadale
Design Intern
Design Innovation Centre,
IIT Hyderabad

Career Pathways

The Bachelor of Design program prepares students for a wide range of careers across contemporary creative industries, emerging technologies, research, entrepreneurship, and social innovation. The interdisciplinary nature of the curriculum enables graduates to work across multiple domains while adapting to rapidly changing professional environments.

Students develop strong capabilities in communication, research, visualization, storytelling, systems thinking, problem-solving, collaboration, and creative leadership, allowing them to contribute meaningfully across diverse sectors.

Graduates may pursue careers in design studios, media organizations, technology companies, creative agencies, cultural institutions, research organizations, public systems, start-ups, and independent practice.



Emerging Professional Opportunities

As technology, media, and society continue to evolve, the role of designers is expanding beyond traditional professional boundaries. Contemporary designers increasingly shape products, services, systems, experiences, policies, and social interventions.

The program prepares students to engage with emerging fields, including:

- User Experience (UX) Design
- User Interface (UI) Design
- Interaction Design
- Service Design
- Design Research
- Brand Strategy and Communication
- Information Design
- Motion Graphics and Animation
- Illustration and Visual Narratives
- Editorial and Publication Design
- Experience Design
- Game Design
- Immersive Media (AR/VR/XR)
- Creative Technology
- Social Innovation and Public Interest Design
- Design Entrepreneurship



The curriculum emphasizes adaptability and lifelong learning, enabling graduates to remain relevant within evolving technological and professional landscapes.

Higher Education Opportunities

The BDes program provides a strong foundation for advanced study in design, art, communication, media, technology, humanities, and interdisciplinary research. Graduates may pursue postgraduate education in areas such as:

- Communication Design
- Interaction Design
- Design Research
- Animation and Moving Image
- Film Studies
- Visual Culture
- Human-Computer Interaction
- Service and Systems Design
- Strategic Design
- Innovation Studies
- Digital Media
- Creative Technology
- Fine Arts and Contemporary Art Practices

The interdisciplinary nature of the curriculum equips students with the intellectual and professional foundation required for both specialised and transdisciplinary postgraduate studies.



Research, Innovation and Entrepreneurship

Design today plays an important role in innovation, knowledge creation, and social transformation. Students are encouraged to move beyond conventional problem-solving approaches and engage with research, experimentation, and entrepreneurial thinking.

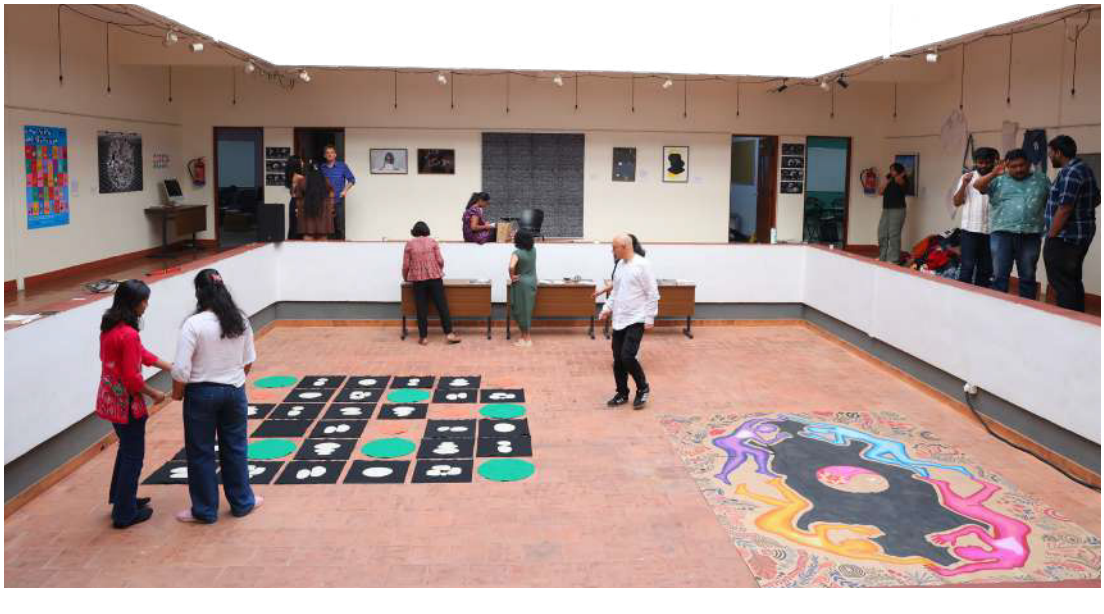
Through independent projects, interdisciplinary collaborations, industry engagement, and research-led inquiry, students learn how to identify opportunities, develop ideas, test concepts, and create meaningful interventions.

The program supports students who aspire to establish creative practices, launch start-ups, pursue independent artistic careers, or contribute to research and innovation ecosystems.

Industry Readiness

Professional preparation is embedded throughout the four-year learning journey. Students engage with real-world projects, internships, workshops, industry interactions, exhibitions, and collaborative initiatives that expose them to contemporary professional practices.
Rather than preparing students for a single profession, the program develops adaptable individuals capable of navigating multiple career pathways throughout their lives.

Emphasis is placed on portfolio development, communication skills, teamwork, critical thinking, project management, ethical decision-making, and professional responsibility.
These capabilities enable graduates to contribute effectively within diverse organisational, entrepreneurial, and independent contexts.



Scholarship - up to 100%*

Profile-Based Scholarships to Encourage Diversity

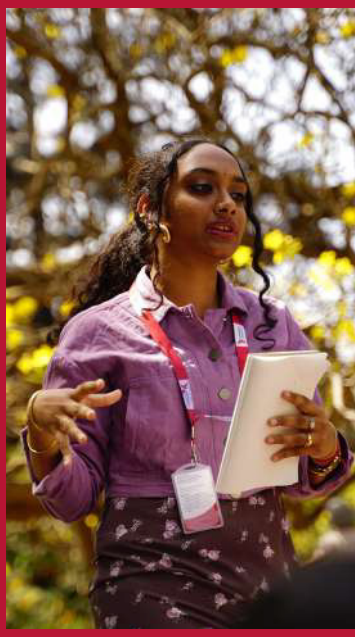
₹ 28+ crore awarded in scholarships since 2022

- P. Dayananda Pai Scholarship
- SAT scholarships
- Talent-based scholarships
- Need-based scholarships
- Dean's Honor Scholarship
- Other Categories

Admissions

1. *Submission of the application*
2. *Evaluation of the application based on the academic and non-academic profiles*
3. *Interaction with academic counselor and expert committee*
4. *Portfolio and document evaluation if eligible for a scholarship*
5. *Result notification with the Letter of Selection*
6. *Admission confirmation after the payment of acceptance fee and fulfilment of eligibility criteria*

*Subject to University Scholarship Policy



Know More

Message from the Dean

We live in a time of profound transformation. Artificial intelligence, digital technologies, ecological challenges, and rapidly changing social realities are reshaping how we communicate, create, and work. In such a context, design cannot be understood merely as the creation of products, images, or services. It has become a critical way of understanding complexity, solving problems, and shaping meaningful futures.

At Vidyashilp University, we believe that design education must move beyond conventional models focused solely on technical skills. While professional competence remains essential, future designers must also possess critical thinking, conceptual clarity, adaptability, and an understanding of the socio-cultural, technological, and environmental contexts within which design operates.

The Bachelor of Design program at VU is conceived as an interdisciplinary and future-oriented learning environment that combines strong foundations in visual communication, interaction design, film, animation, digital media, storytelling, game design and emerging technologies with research, systems thinking, and creative inquiry. Through studio-based learning, industry projects, internships, workshops, field engagement, and independent exploration, students develop both professional expertise and intellectual depth.

Our goal is to prepare graduates for diverse opportunities in industry, entrepreneurship, research, and the creative economy. As technology increasingly automates production and execution, the designer's value lies in imagination, critical judgment, collaboration, and the ability to navigate complexity. We encourage students not only to learn how to design, but also to ask why, for whom, and with what impact.

At VU, we aspire to nurture thoughtful, skilled, and entrepreneurial designers who can contribute meaningfully to industry and society while shaping more sustainable, inclusive, and responsible futures.

Narendra Raghunath
Dean
School of Design



The Future of Design

The future of Design will be shaped by artificial intelligence, ecological challenges, evolving communication systems, new forms of media, and changing social realities. Designers will increasingly be required to work across disciplines, cultures, technologies, and communities.

At Vidyashilp University, future designers must possess not only technical competence and creative confidence, but also intellectual curiosity, ethical awareness, cultural sensitivity, and social responsibility.

The ability to understand complex realities critically, collaborate across domains, and imagine alternative possibilities will become as important as the ability to create products, services, interfaces, or visual systems.

The School of Design seeks to nurture graduates who can contribute meaningfully to society while helping shape more inclusive, sustainable, and humane futures.

Join a Community of Creative Thinkers and Makers

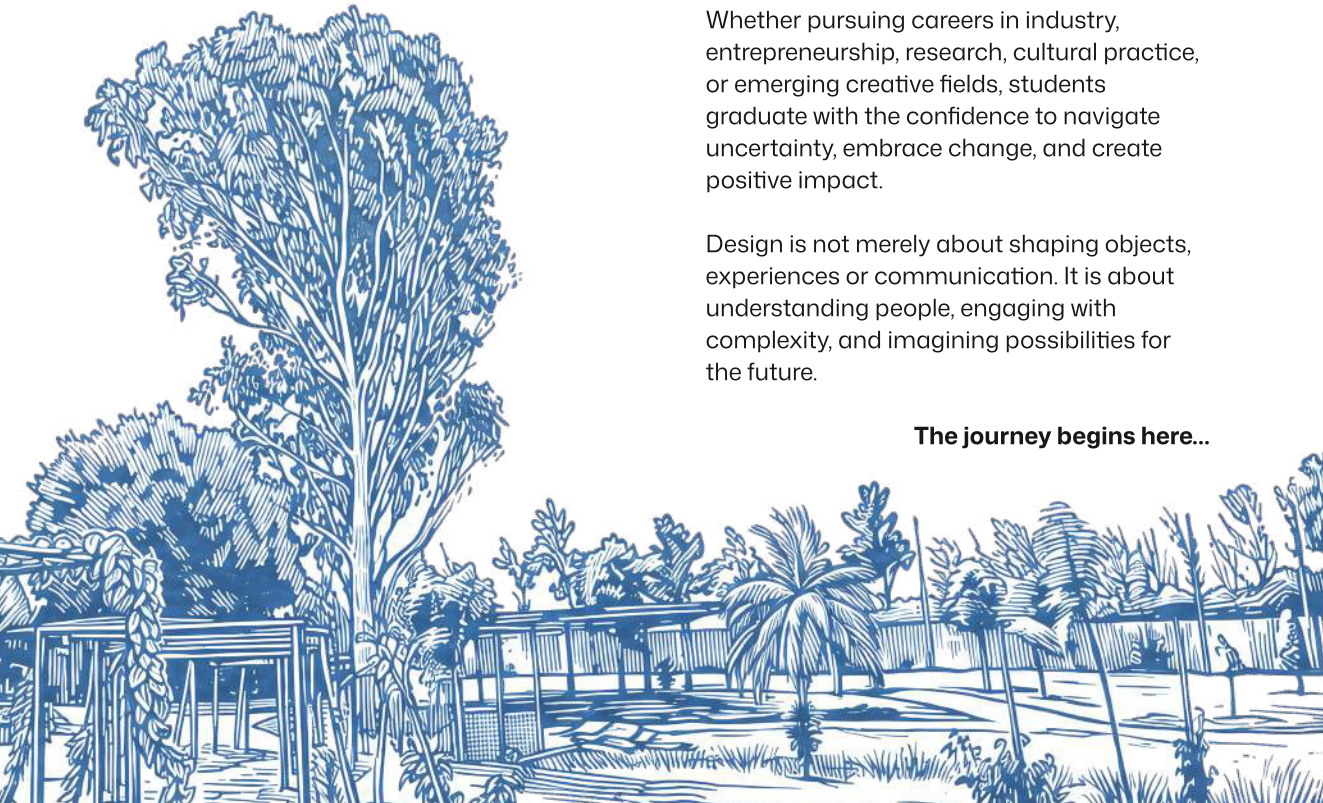
The School of Design at Vidyashilp University is more than a professional training environment. It is a community of learners, educators, researchers, artists, designers, technologists, and creative practitioners engaged in exploring the possibilities of design in a rapidly changing world.

Through interdisciplinary learning, creative experimentation, global engagement, research, and professional practice, students are encouraged to discover their unique strengths while developing the knowledge, skills, and perspectives required for meaningful contribution.

Whether pursuing careers in industry, entrepreneurship, research, cultural practice, or emerging creative fields, students graduate with the confidence to navigate uncertainty, embrace change, and create positive impact.

Design is not merely about shaping objects, experiences or communication. It is about understanding people, engaging with complexity, and imagining possibilities for the future.

The journey begins here...



Apply Now

VIDYASHILP UNIVERSITY | VIDYASHILP SCHOOL OF DESIGN

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